Staff answers and teaching notes

Outcome and boundaries

Use a calming strategy independently.

Low-pressure practice only, with calm invented third-person scenes. Do not induce a big feeling, ask for a personal trigger, require distress to start, or make calming down a condition of success. Learner may pass, stop, switch or seek private help. A safe try can be recorded even if it did not feel helpful. Pupil feedback remains their own, not filled by an adult.

Three routines

slow breathing

Use a familiar school-agreed gentle routine at a comfortable personal pace. No forced deep breath, breath-holding, phase counts, prescribed rate or closed eyes. Visual IN/OUT is a cue, not a paced demand. If uncomfortable, stop/choose another option.

grounding count

A short authored 3–2–1 notice-and-count activity, not a treatment protocol. Normal setting only, eyes open; no taste, smell, unfamiliar object or touching another person. Use usual sensory access. If an element does not suit the learner, choose another routine or an already agreed access adaptation; no requirement to tolerate uncomfortable sensations.

movement reset

Use a familiar agreed small movement, seated or supported in the usual safe position. No stretch/range target, squeezing, force or physical performance grade. Stop if uncomfortable. Usual physical/sensory adaptations remain; choose another routine if this movement does not suit.

Timer

One quiet practice of up to 30 seconds, after the learner has chosen and set up. Stop earlier if needed; no race or requirement to fill the time. Adult operates a familiar quiet visual timer with no sudden alarm. Timer operation is normal access, not a prompt telling the next strategy step. Do not count breath phases with the timer.

Model check

IN soft in, OUT soft out, own comfortable pace, no hold/rate/phase count. The visual labels cue an action; they do not prescribe timing. Stop/change/help options remain. Supported rehearsal is teaching, not evidence of later independent use.

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Independent use and own feedback

Main and parallel hinge

Main B: chosen card, visible model and usual aids can stay while adult refrains from next-step content cues. False A removes all aids. Parallel A: No or Not sure is valid own Did it help? feedback; false B treats it as failure. Re-model and recheck privately; a pass unobserved.

Evidence of actual use

After teaching and a general task cue, observe the learner choose/start/use their selected routine with their card, visible model and usual aids, without adult step-by-step content prompts. Record what was actually seen and any prompts. A scribe may record a choice or reflection but cannot substitute for the learner using a routine. Choosing to stop or seek help is respected; do not invent completed practice or claim independence when adult step cues were needed.

Use the three exact recording states: Used steps with card/usual aids and no adult step prompts; Used steps with adult step prompts; Practice not observed this time. A visible card or scribed explanation does not prove actual practice. Record only actions actually observed/known, any next-step prompts and gaps. Do not infer breath depth, physiology, distress or health benefit from appearance.

Own feedback

Did it help? Yes, A bit, No and Not sure all valid. Do not fill the learner’s mark from the adult’s view, treat No as failure or require Yes for independent use. Choice/feedback may be pointed or faithfully scribed, while the routine itself remains the learner’s action.

Keep card

Each learner keeps a choose-your-strategy reference card with all three short names/steps, a choice space and an initially unticked Did it help? choice. Point/select a routine; adult can mark the chosen option faithfully. Keep in the book or usual accessible place. No personal trigger or current-feeling question.

Next step

Record one useful next step based on what happened: practise a step with support, choose another agreed routine, or agree an access change. Keep first try and reply distinct. Actual content prompting is logged, not hidden by an independent label.

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Scaffolds access and private help

Scaffolds for each task

Starter
Bank: card, help, stop. Starter: They could pick ... . Visible model: Story A picks the soft breath card.

Model check
Bank: in, out, soft, stop. Starter: In ... . Out ... . Visible model: Soft breath in; soft breath out. No hold.

Guided count and move
Bank: three, two, one, open, close, rest. Starter: First ... . Then ... . Visible model: A uses IN, then OUT, at their own pace.

Private hinge
Bank: card, own, prompt, help. Starter: They can use ... . Visible model: A uses the card; the adult does not give each step.

Choose and plan
Bank: breath, count, move, stop. Starter: They could pick ... . Visible model: Story A picks soft breath. Other safe cards can fit.

Timed practice and check
Bank: card, try, stop, yes, no. Starter: My card is ... . Did it help? ... . Visible model: A tries with the card. The help tick is their own.

Feedback and exit
Bank: card, help, next. Starter: A next step could be ... . Visible model: A can keep the card and ask for help next time.

Access and marking
Supported, Independent and Aspire retain all seven Level 2 aid sets. Normal timer/reading/sensory/physical/communication access remains; adult step content cues are separate. Exact scribe reads choice/feedback back and allows correction. E actual work saved; R after Voice, Audience, NS/reply. Offer to Communication portfolio; staff confirm mapping. Formative Week 3; Week 6 assessing.

Staff disclosure note
If a pupil discloses, listen calmly, reassure and pass the concern to the safeguarding lead through the school’s procedure. Do not probe or promise secrecy. Keep details out of this pack and shared evidence.

Delivery scope
40 minutes in 12/13/15-minute chunks, two one-minute resets within total. Up-to-30-second quiet try, no race/alarm or breath pacing. Only Week 3 authored. No later weeks or separate RSE content. Pause for Downloaded.

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